

	Idle RAM	RAM During scan	Time
AVG Antivirus 7.5	5.34 MB	9.56 MB	0:20:09
e-Scan	4.93 MB	19.37 MB	05:27:86
Avast! 4.7	4.69 MB	5.20 MB	00:19:00
Norton Antivirus 2007	12 MB	24.74 MB	02:58:33

We should mention here that when testing we found a folder from a removable drive containing Win32:Pirate, and e-Scan just didn't detect the virus. Avast!, on the other hand, didn't allow access to the file till we cleaned it. Norton Antivirus 2007 contains a firewall and an anti-spyware built into the package, but we thought dedicated software like ZoneAlarm for a firewall and Spybot Search & Destroy for spyware do a better job, using fewer resources.

The table indicates that Avast! fared better than the other software both in terms of speed and resources consumed. The interface is cleaner, with no learning curve needed to use the software. Best of all, this anti-virus is free for personal use, making it an essential software for every system.

6.6 Spybot Search & Destroy 1.4

SS&D is designed to search for and destroy spyware. Having installed SS&D you can easily initiate a scan using the "Check for problems" button. The results would indicate the files or modules affected by spyware. They would also indicate your "Usage tracks", which are basically the files and the modules you have been working on. Spybot works in two modes—the Default and the Advanced mode. Most settings can be modified only in Advanced mode. It might be a good idea to operate at all times in Default mode and switch to Advanced mode only when you need to change the settings.

Important settings available:

- Categories of threats to be searched for
- Backups of fixed spyware and usage tracks
- Display confirmation before making critical changes
- Schedule program for auto-scan